

BOYS BASKETBALL: DISTRICT FINAL



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

Olmsted Falls players hold up the Division I district championship trophy Saturday night.

Braddick sets the tone

Unheralded junior scores 23 points in Bulldogs' win

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Pat Braddick may not get the ink nor command the attention of Steve Gansey and Dan Binggeli, his Olmsted Falls teammates.

It's probably just as well, because St. Edward's sixth-ranked basketball team never saw him coming Saturday night at Midview.

With Gansey playing under the weight of three personal fouls and Binggeli struggling with just three points in the second half, Braddick broadsided the Eagles like a big truck.

The 6-foot-3 junior scored 16 second-half points on his way to a career-high 23 and it was just what the Bulldogs needed in their huge Division I district championship victory.

It put him in an unfamiliar position.

"This is unbelievable," Braddick said in the midst of a loud celebration of the Bulldogs' 67-58 victory, their 21st in 23 games. "It's not my role to do the scoring and stuff, but they gave me open looks."

The open looks showed him the way to 10 points in the third quarter, which he opened with a putback that increased the 'Dogs' lead to 33-28. He followed with a layup 2½ minutes into the period, then drained two long 3-pointers later in the quarter.

The second one, with 1:47 left in the period, stretched the Olmsted Falls lead to 47-40.

St. Ed, to no one's surprise, took the lead back, 48-47, less than a minute into the fourth quarter and, in fact, the lead changed hands five more times in the next 4½ minutes.

But when Braddick drove for a basket with 3:30 to play, he put the Bulldogs on top for good, 55-54. Less than 30 seconds later, he clicked on two foul shots. And when he scored a layup out of Falls' clock-eating control offense with 1:37 left, the Bulldog lead was 59-54.

"I couldn't do anything without Dan and Steve and all those guys," Braddick said. "It was a great team win. I was just trying to stay calm. We were all starting to get excited and everything. I don't know, I've never been here before. It's a great experience. I love it."

No one loved it more than Bulldog coach Pat Donahue.

"Braddick had an outstanding game," said Donahue.

Eagle coach Eric Flannery was every bit as impressed.

"We obviously put a lot of focus on their three main guys (Gansey, Binggeli and Jamar Scales), but (Braddick) stepped up and played. That's what we felt they had to do if they were going to beat us. And they did."

Olmsted Falls was the tournament's second-seeded team, behind St. Edward. Therefore, the Bulldogs' win must have been an upset.

"Absolutely not," Braddick said with great alacrity. "Absolutely not! We came into this game feeling we could beat these guys. We thought we could play with them and we proved it. I hope we get some respect now."

Binggeli got the same question.

"It's not really an upset because we're up there with them," said Binggeli. "I mean, we're not ranked but I know we're one of the top teams."

And so did Gansey.

"I wouldn't say it's an upset, because we're compared pretty evenly," said Gansey. "I think tonight was just two great Northeast Ohio basketball teams going at each other."

Notes

● A Cleveland television crew arrived in the jam-packed Midview gym to tape some atmosphere and action.

● Olmsted Falls fans, in a festive mood even before the big victory, tailgated in and near the Midview parking lot. Some students let off steam throwing around a football.

● The Wellington boys varsity squad was in the full house of 1,700, seated in the front row on the south side of the court. In case you were wondering, that was the St. Edward side.

● A sign at the Capel Road entrance to the parking lot was pretty clear: "SOLD OUT." It didn't deter everyone who showed up without a ticket. Some fans wandered among parked cars asking if anyone had extra tickets for sale.

● Well before the doors opened at 6 p.m., some fans were knocking on them hoping to get in early.

● The always-colorful Olmsted Falls student section showed up dressed, painted and otherwise swathed in Bulldog blue and gold, many of them wearing shorts despite the outside chill. One even wore a gray, mascot-like bulldog head, to the delight of everyone else.

FALLS

From D1

to the Division I Sweet 16 after spending the past decade in Division II. Nonetheless, it's their first trip to the regional since winning the now-departed Admiral King Division II district seven times over the course of 11 years — the last coming in 2001.

Good teams find ways to overcome obstacles. Olmsted Falls did just that. It outrebounded a taller team 39-35, and won in spite of its leading scorer — Gansey — at less than his normal production.

Gansey had 30 points against Southview in Falls' opening tournament win and added 33 vs. Elyria in the district semifinal. He was limited to 15 points Saturday night.

"Our plan was pretty simple," said Flannery. "Try to play great half-court, man-to-man defense and try to get the ball inside. We did a terrible job of getting the ball inside."

When St. Edward got the ball in Moore's hands, it scored. Moore had 17 points to lead the Eagles and hit eight of his 11 shots — all in the paint. He also drew two fouls — both called on Gansey.

The problem was elementary. St. Ed's took too many shots in the early going from the perimeter. The Eagles only found the mark five times in 27 attempts (18.5 percent) and some of the attempts weren't even close.

"We wanted to play that guy tough," Donahue said when asked about Moore. "We weren't going to sit back and let them get the ball down low and score on us all the time. We told our guards we wanted to double-down as much as possible and try to keep the ball out of his hands. I thought we did a fairly good job with that."

The Eagles were on the verge of taking control when they scored 10 unanswered points at the outset of the second quarter to take a 28-20 lead with just under four minutes left before intermission.

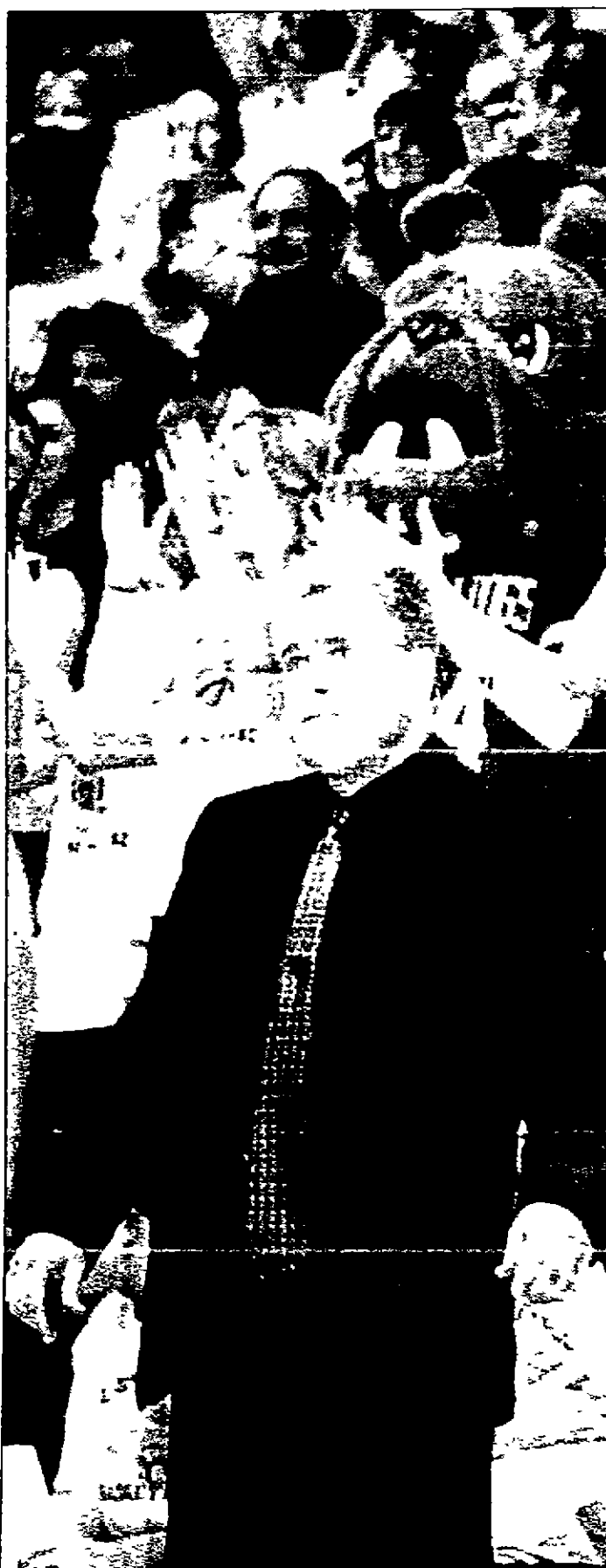
"We went through a stretch of just pulling up and shooting threes," Flannery said. "We had an eight-point lead. That just kept them in the game."

The Eagles did not score again in the second quarter, and when Mental stroked a 3-pointer from the right baseline, Falls led 31-28 as the buzzer sounded.

"St. Ed's is a great team," Donahue said. "They really are. But we felt we played some people that got us ready for this game. A couple of the teams we played already in the tournament got us ready. We really wanted to play St. Ed's."

"I can't say (Falls) wanted it more," said Flannery, "but they sure got after it at both ends of the floor. Offensively, they shot the ball with confidence. Defensively, they played as aggressive as we did, if not more."

From there it was nip-and-



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue takes a look at the scoreboard in the final seconds of his team's district final victory over top-seeded St. Edward on Saturday night.

tuck. Falls built a 37-30 lead early in the second half but the Eagles whittled it back to 47-44 by the end of the third quarter.

The lead changed hands five times early in the final quarter before Braddock hit a shot from close range at 3:28 and buried a pair of free throws to give Falls a 57-54 lead with 3:07 left.

Had the Bulldogs cashed in a little better from the foul line, they may have had an easier time. Falls was just 17-of-23 in the final quarter. The fact it reached the line that many times was important. St. Edward took just eight throws from the line.

Dan Binggeli had his usual

quiet but productive night. He scored 12 points and pulled in eight rebounds.

Ryan Marando scored 14 and grabbed nine rebounds for Ed's.

OLMSTED FALLS (67) Mickey Mental 11-4 Dan Binggeli 5-1 12 Pat Braddock 9-3-23 Jamar Scales 2-5-9 Steve Gansey 4-5-15 Cory Sparks 0-0-0 Aden Rockhold 1-0-2 Jason Taylor 0-2-2 Eddie Aram 0-0-0 Totals 22-17-67.

LAKEWOOD ST. EDWARD (58) John Curran 4-0-9 Trent Morgan 2-2-7 Ryan Marando 5-2-14 Chris Moore 8-1-17 Kyle Hubbard 1-0-2 Kevin Reese 0-0-0 Bob Bernhard 0-0-0 Anthony Cassner 1-0-2 Josh Skelton 3-0-7 Totals 24-5-58.

Olmsted Falls 19 12 16 20 — 67 St. Edward 18 10 16 14 — 58 Field goals: Olmsted Falls 22-51 (43 percent) St. Edward 24-50 (48 percent) Three-pointers: Olmsted Falls 6-12 (50 percent) St. Edward 7-23 (30 percent) Free Throws: Olmsted Falls 17-30 (57 percent) St. Edward 5-8 (62.5 percent) Rebounds: Olmsted Falls 39 (Scales 9, Braddock 6) St. Edward 35 (Marando 9, Morgan 8) Fouls: Olmsted Falls 10 St. Edward 11 Fouled Out: None

WEIGHTLIFTING

Brookside hosts, wins contest

Paul Heyse
The Chronicle-Telegram

SHEFFIELD VILLAGE — It boiled down to show-up, put-up or shut-up time for athletes competing at Saturday's third-annual Brookside Bench Competition Invitational.

Brookside rose to the occasion for the third straight year. The Cardinals squeezed past Westlake — 3,225 pounds to 3,175 pounds — in the 10-team competition.

The Cardinals won five of 12 weight divisions. Jeff Sharkey (140-149), Geoff Senko (170-179), Kirk Wangbickler (190-199), Kyle Koachway (200-209) and Josh Vanderhoof (250 and above) won individual honors.

Koachway, a senior guard from the football team, captured heavyweight MVP honors. He benched 82.6 pounds over his bodyweight.

"I've never placed in this competition," said Koachway. "I figured I've got to bust my butt as hard as I can. I'm a senior and I just wanted to give it my all."

In the last year he's upgraded his training regimen from three times a week to five times per week.

"It feels awesome. I didn't expect this at all," said Koachway. "I injured my rotator cuff early during football season and missed most of the season. My mindset coming in was simply to do my best, and I did."

Brookside finished sixth out of 20 teams at last year's state competition.

"As a team, we're just hoping to maintain this trend," said Koachway. "Hopefully, we can keep this momentum for the



RACHEL ORTEGA / CHRONICLE

Brookside junior Dennis Page watches as classmate Kyle Baumann finishes a round with a 205-pound lift on Saturday.

state competition (at Kenton) next weekend."

Senko, last year's invite champion of the 160-169 weight class, set a meet record for the second year in a row. The Cardinals defensive back benched 305 pounds, a total of 125.2 pounds over his bodyweight.

"I thought benching 325 pounds would be cool, but 305 is all right," said Senko, who will play football for Adrian College in the fall. "I've done 335 before.

I'm a little displeased, but the state meet is the ultimate goal. The state meet is the combination of all three lifts (bench, squat and dead-lift). We're just working for that."

Southview senior Roberto Casteneda, who lifted for Brookside the past two years, captured lightweight MVP honors. He won the 150-159 title on a tiebreaker over Brookside senior Kevin Hendrickson. Casteneda benched 265 pounds —

115 pounds over his bodyweight. Hendrickson lifted 106 pounds over his own weight.

"Honestly, Kevin should have won," said Casteneda, who will attend the Naval Academy in August. "The only reason I won is because Kevin missed his weight."

The two tied last year for the 140-149 title.

Team scores

TOP THREE TEAMS
1. Brookside, 3,225 pounds; 2. Westlake, 3,175 pounds; 3. South Central, 2,715 pounds.

Individual results

LIGHTWEIGHT DIVISION

120-129: 1. Jeff Sharkey (Brookside), 160 pounds/31 pounds over bodyweight; 2. David Sazone (Adrian High), 159/27; 3. Sean Quinn (Brookside), 149/22.
130-139: 1. Nick Swarczewsky (Lakewood), 245/110 (MEET RECORD, old record 240 set in 2002 by Southview's Dave Mercado and tied in 2003 by Lakewood's Mike Braddock); 2. Eric Stiller (Fairview), 235/97; 3. Chan Hua Tong (Brookside), 230/86.
140-149: 1. Mike Braddock (Lakewood), 255/113; 2. Chris Zahner (South Central), 245/99; 3. Chase Reagan (Westlake), 255/76.
150-159: 1. Roberto Casteneda (Southview), 265/115; 2. Kevin Hendrickson (Brookside), 265/106; 3. Jim Fan (Westlake), 240/83.
Lightweight MVP: Casteneda.

MIDDLEWEIGHT DIVISION

160-169: 1. Kaleb McCormack (South Central), 310/144 (MEET RECORD, old record 280 set in 2002 by Edison's Trevor Harlow and tied in 2003 by Brookside's Geoff Senko); 2. Jon Hixson (Lakewood), 300/139; 3. Chris Kozles (Westlake), 275/114.
170-179: 1. Senko (Brookside), 305/125 (MEET RECORD, old record 285 set in 2003 by McCormack); 2. Troy Taitlin (Western Reserve), 280/101; 3. Steve Hausholder (Brookside), 280/94.
180-189: 1. Mike Coburn (South Central), 320/172 (MEET RECORD, old record 300 set in 2002 by Fairview's John Donahue); 2. Dan Ricci (Westlake), 300/144; 3. Craig Wood (Adrian High), 290/82.
190-199: 1. Kirk Wangbickler (Brookside), 310/114; 2. Brad Thomschick (Westlake), 285/93; 3. Danie Marinucci (Westlake), 285/83.
Middleweight MVP: McCormack.

HEAVYWEIGHT DIVISION

200-209: 1. Kyle Koachway (Brookside), 255/82.6; 2. Brian Carr (Westlake), 250/48.2; 3. Nick Huff (Westlake), 235/28.8.
210-229: 1. Kyle Hargreaves (Westlake), 275/60.8; 2. Blake Stodder (Brookside), 210/0; 3. David Wie (Brookside), 255/53.2.
230-249: 1. Sam Campbell (Westlake), 300/53.2; 2. Stan Peters (Brookside), 300/53.2; 3. Adam Risher (South Central), 225/0.
250 and above: 1. Josh Vanderhoof (Brookside), 320/146; 2. Jeremy Dembski (Westlake), 300/35; 3. Steve Albright (Brookside), 255/1.
Heavyweight MVP: Koachway.

BASKETBALL

Saturday's results

BOYS DISTRICTS

DIVISION I

Cols. Miller 59, Lancaster 52
Dublin Coffman 64, Hilliard Darby 52
Columbus Eastern 58, Portsmouth Sackville 54, OT
S. Webster 63, Gloucester Tumble 50
Willard 68, Shelby 60
Zanesville Rosecrans 64, Berlin Highland 49

DIVISION II

Akr. SVSM 67, Akr. Buchtel 56
Canal Fulton NW 70, Orville 68, OT
Cuyahoga Falls Walsh Jesuit 17-6 vs. Tallmadge 51
Greenfield McClain 65, McArthur Vinton County 59
Ottawa-Glandorf 60, Wauseon 43
Warrensville Hts. 69, Fairview Park Fairview 49
Youngs Liberty 78, Morrow Howland 60

DIVISION III

Bellevue Clear Fork 37, Bucyrus Wynford 31
Chesapeake 40, Piqueton 24
Findlay Liberty-Benton 60, Hamler Patrick Henry 46
Ironton 62, Williamsport Westfall 59, OT
Loudonville 59, Akron Manchester 42
St. Henry 45, Lima Cent. Cath. 33

DIVISION IV

Cols. African 53, Lancaster Fisher Cath. 49
Reedsville Eastern 58, Portsmouth Sackville 54, OT
S. Webster 63, Gloucester Tumble 50
Willard 68, Shelby 60
Zanesville Rosecrans 64, Berlin Highland 49

GIRLS REGIONALS

DIVISION I

Day Chamade-Juvenile 56, Cin. Princeton 41
Oak Hill 61, Worthington Christian 51
Plan City Jonathan Alder 41, Cin. Madiera 35
Smithville 41, Oregon Strich 28
Youngs Ursuline 85, S. Euclid Regina 52

DIVISION II

Berlin Highland 49, Morral Ridgepole 25
Mansfield St. Peter's 72, Lovelockville 35
Miller City 51, Stryker 28
Minster 41, Ft. Loraine 32

DIVISION III

Chesterland W. Geauga (21-2) vs. Youngs Liberty (19-4), Wednesday, 7 p.m., Warrensville Hts. (11-12) vs. Canal Fulton NW (21-1), Thursday, 7 p.m., Mansfield (19-4), Thursday, 8 p.m.

DIVISION IV

Chesterland W. Geauga (21-2) vs. Youngs Liberty (19-4), Wednesday, 7 p.m., Warrensville Hts. (11-12) vs. Canal Fulton NW (21-1), Thursday, 7 p.m., Mansfield (19-4), Thursday, 8 p.m.

BOYS REGIONAL SEMIFINALS

DIVISION I

Olmsted Falls (21-2) vs. Mansfield St. (17-6), Thursday, 8:15 p.m., St. John's (20-4) vs. Cle. Rhodes (16-8), Thursday, 8 p.m.

DIVISION II

At Fairgrounds Coliseum, Columbus
Cols. Brookhaven (25-2) vs. Dublin Coffman (14-9), Wednesday, 7 p.m., Mosler (21-2) vs. Cols. Madiera (20-3), Thursday, 7 p.m.

DIVISION III

At University of Akron
Can. McKinley (20-3) vs. Medina (16-8), Wednesday, 7 p.m., Col. Colwellwood (20-3) vs. Bedford (14-9), Thursday, 7 p.m.

DIVISION IV

At University of Dayton
Cin. Sycamore (19-10) vs. Hamilton St. (21-2), Thursday, 8:15 p.m., Cin. LaSalle (23-1) vs. Spring S. (22-2), Thursday, 8 p.m.

DIVISION I

At Canton Civic Center
Chesterland W. Geauga (21-2) vs. Youngs Liberty (19-4), Wednesday, 7 p.m., Warrensville Hts. (11-12) vs. Canal Fulton NW (21-1), Thursday, 7 p.m., Mansfield (19-4), Thursday, 8 p.m.

DIVISION II

At Fairgrounds Coliseum, Columbus
S. Webster (20-3) vs. Reedsville Eastern (15-7), Tuesday, 6:15 p.m., Col. Anacostia (11-13) vs. Mansfield St. Peter's (19-4), Tuesday 8 p.m.

DIVISION III

At Bowling Green State
Tiffin Calvert (15-8) vs. Holgate (16-7), Tuesday, 6:30 p.m., Cin. Mt. More Dame (26-6) vs. Sylvana Northwest (26-0), Friday, 8 p.m.

DIVISION IV

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DIVISION I

At Miami University, Oxford
Mansfield St. Peter's (19-4) vs. Van Buren (18-4), Tuesday 8:15 p.m.

DIVISION II

At Canton Fieldhouse
Windham (16-8) vs. Sebring McKinley (22-1), Tuesday, 6:15 p.m., Cin. Mt. More Dame (26-6) vs. Sylvana Northwest (26-0), Friday, 8 p.m.

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